Ford Motor Company

October 2001

Ford Motor Company thanks you for your continued patience with the Firestone Wilderness AT (15-,16-, and 17-inch) tire replacement program. We're sending this letter to inform you that our Ford and Mercury Dealers now have an ample supply of replacement tires, to update you on the recent U.S. Department of Transportation's National Highway Traffic Safety Administration (NHTSA) announcement regarding Firestone Wilderness AT tires, and to provide further details if you still need to have your tires replaced.

Replace Firestone Wilderness AT Tires At A Ford Or Mercury Dealer Through March 31, 2002 – At No Cost To You.

To date, we have replaced more than 7 million tires – or 55% – of the total Wilderness AT tires on Ford Motor Company vehicles. The availability of tires has continued to improve, and dealers now have an ample supply of replacement tires. Therefore, it is no longer necessary for you to replace tires on your own and then seek reimbursement. The Ford Motor Company's Firestone Wilderness AT tire replacement program will last through March 31, 2002, in order for you to have enough time to get your tires replaced.

Bridgestone/Firestone's Tire Recall Announcement Does Not Change Ford's Replacement Program.

Our program to replace all 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Wilderness AT tires is not changed by Bridgestone/Firestone's recently announced expanded safety recall. Ford Motor Company will continue to replace your Wilderness AT tires at no cost to you. On October 4, NHTSA requested that Bridgestone/Firestone expand the Firestone tire safety recall announced in August of 2000. Bridgestone/Firestone has agreed to comply with NHTSA's request and recall Wilderness AT P235/75 R15 and P255/70 R16 tires produced before May 1998. These Firestone Wilderness AT tires were already included in our May 2001 announcement.

Our strong recommendation is that you have your Wilderness AT tires replaced by your local participating Ford or Mercury Dealer as soon as possible. NHTSA also stated that since Bridgestone/Firestone made changes to the Wilderness AT tire in May 1998, and because tread separations rarely occur in these tires before three years, the government would continue to monitor the performance of these tires, which are not included in the safety recall. Meanwhile, we stand by our original action taken in May 2001 and will not use Wilderness AT tires in Ford's tire replacement program. Ford Motor Company is committed to voluntarily replacing all 15-, 16-, and 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires on our vehicles at no cost to you.

What We Are Asking You To Do.

In an effort to complete the tire replacement process as quickly as possible, we ask that you call your local Ford or Mercury Dealer to schedule an appointment right away. Please refer to the information below for assistance in locating a participating dealer near you.

Dealer	Contact Information		Hours of Operation for Phone Contact
Ford and Mercury Dealers	www.dealerconnection.com	1-866-300-1226	8 a.m. to 11 p.m. EST, 7 days a week

For your convenience, when you have your tires replaced at a Ford or Mercury Dealer, there is no out-of-pocket cost to you. However, if a Ford or Mercury Dealer cannot meet your scheduling needs or does not have tires in stock, you may also have your tires replaced at an authorized Goodyear, Continental-General or Michelin tire retailer. The chart below is provided to assist you in locating an authorized tire retailer in your area.

Authorized Tire Retailer	Contact Information		Hours of Operation for Phone Contact
Michelin	www.michelin-us.com	N/A	N/A
Continental-General	www.generaltire.com	1-800-847-3349	8 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. EST, M-F
Goodyear	www.goodyeardealers.com	1-800-GOODYEAR	24 hours, 7 days a week

If you have your tires replaced at one of these retailers, there should not be any out-of-pocket cost to you for their services either. We are working together with dealers and authorized tire retailers to ensure that this process is as simple as possible for you. As a result, we will no longer accept refund requests for tires purchased after November 15, 2001. Please know that we have advised all tire retailers of this deadline.

Our dealers are committed to providing you with quality tires, professional service, and customer-friendly hours of operation. And once again, by using your local Ford or Mercury Dealer for tire replacement, there will be no out-of-pocket cost to you. However, to ensure that you are not charged for this service when having your tires replaced at an authorized retailer other than a Ford or Mercury Dealer, please take this letter and the enclosed service agreement form with you. The authorized retailer has been instructed to fill out the service agreement form and provide a copy to you for your records.

In order to better serve you, we need your help in ensuring that our records are up to date. If you have sold this vehicle or have changed your address, please take a minute to complete and mail the enclosed postcard.

Refund Information – Until November 15, 2001.

As stated previously, your Ford or Mercury Dealer or authorized tire retailer will replace any 15-, 16-, or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires on your Ford Motor Company vehicle, free of charge. However, if you pay (or have paid) prior to November 15, 2001, to have your tires replaced, please refer to the chart below for refund information. While our tire replacement program continues through March 31, 2002, we will no longer accept refund requests for tires purchased after November 15, 2001.

If you replaced your tires between the dates:	Your refund amount will be:	What you need to obtain for a refund:
August 1, 2000, through May 22, 2001	• The actual cost as stated on the paid receipt for replacing tires, including mounting, balancing, valve stems, disposal, and taxes	• Original paid receipt • See your Ford or Mercury Dealer for refund information
May 23, 2001, through November 15, 2001	• 15-inch tires – $110 per tire (includes mounting, balancing, stems, disposal, and taxes) • 16- and 17-inch tires – $130 per tire (includes mounting, balancing, stems, disposal, and taxes)	• Original paid receipt • DOT code section from each tire replaced. (Ask tire retailer to cut this section from each tire. The section must contain the entire DOT code and be readable. The purpose of this requirement is to ensure that the replaced tires are rendered unusable and are removed from service. See dealer for complete details.)
After November 15, 2001	• No refunds accepted or paid. **Tires will be replaced free of charge at a participating Ford or Mercury Dealer or authorized tire retailer through March 31, 2002**	• No refunds accepted for tires purchased after November 15, 2001

Tire Maintenance.

You can help to reduce the risk of any type of tire failure by maintaining the tire pressure specified for your vehicle, not overloading your vehicle, and observing posted speed limits. For tire pressure and loading specifications, refer to the vehicle certification label located in the driver's door opening.

If You Have Questions.

If you have further questions regarding this program, please call us toll-free at **1-866-300-1226**, from 8 a.m. to 11 p.m. EST, seven days a week; or e-mail us at tireinquiry@ford.com. For the latest information on-line, go to www.ford.com.

We thank you for your attention to this important matter. Maintaining your safety, your satisfaction, and your trust is our top priority.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Ford Motor Company

ONP 01B77: Ford Firestone Wilderness AT Tire Replacement Program
Agreement for No-Charge Tire Replacement

Note: This form is to be used only when having tires replaced at a tire retailer other than a Ford Motor Company Dealership.

_____ (Tire Retailer Name) will perform the service required for the Ford Firestone Wilderness AT Replacement Program (Owner Notification Program 01B77) at no cost to the customer _____ (Customer Name). This service shall include removal of 15-, 16- or 17-inch Firestone Wilderness AT tires, using only replacement tires from Ford's approved tire list, mounting and balancing of the new tires, and replacement of valve stems and wheel weights, as deemed necessary. These charges include applicable sales, excise, waste taxes, and disposal fees. This agreement does not include any other service charges, such as front end alignments, brake inspections, etc. Any other expenses will be solely the responsibility of the customer.

Customer Signature: _____ Date: _____

Retailer Representative: _____ Date: _____

Vehicle Identification Number (VIN): _____

Retailer Copy: Please attach to Repair Order

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Customer Copy